



Enrich OpenOffice.org with Extensions

This article gives you a basic idea about programming OpenOffice.org with NetBeans support, enhancing the power of the office suite through extensions.

*W*ant to add a feature to OpenOffice.org? You may need to download the source, build it, and then hack it for a feature development or enhancement. After all these efforts, it may take time to be accepted upstream. So the best solution is to create and distribute an extension—someone likes it and is confident of the risks involved, can install and use it.

For this purpose, OOo supports easy development of third-party extensions with the help of an SDK (software development kit). As an extension developer you don't need the required environment (distro, architecture, disk space, etc) for building source, leave alone the knowledge about the

full development cycle of the core. You can start off with extension development with much less effort.

Overview of extensions

Extensions add additional functionality to the core OOo office suite, which can be deployed or removed independently. It can be in the form of UI components, custom functions for Calc, data pilots, new chart types, a spell-checker, etc. Some extensions like templates don't require coding at all, as they are considered non-programmatic extensions.

OOo supports extension development in various languages like C++, Java, Basic, Python, Ruby, etc. It is suggested that